

Timothee MICKUS

PERSONAL DATA

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WORK EXPERIENCE

APR 2022–NOW	Postdoctoral Researcher at UNIVERSITY OF HELSINKI LANGUAGE TECHNOLOGY GROUP
AUG 2018–SEP 2018	Web & NLP Engineer at ELDA, Paris; <i>Development—Web Annotation Interface</i>
NOV 2017–JUL 2018	NLP Data Scientist at ESPRITS COLLABORATIFS, Paris area; <i>NLP—R&D</i>
NOV 2015–NOV 2017	Software Contractor at SPIRICA, Paris; <i>Development—Life Insurance Web Application</i>

EDUCATION & SKILLS

RESEARCH VISITS

FEB 2026–MAR 2026	Research Visit at LLMC research group, National Institute of Informatics, Tokyo
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INTERNSHIPS

FEB 2020–MAR 2020	NLP Intern at AIST AIRC, Tokyo
NOV 2017–JUL 2018	NLP Intern at UNIVERSITÉ PARIS DIDEROT, Paris
JAN 2016–JUN 2016	NLP Intern at UNIVERSITÉ PARIS DIDEROT, Paris
JUN 2015–SEP 2015	NLP Intern at LIPN, UNIVERSITÉ PARIS 13, Paris area

SCHOOL CURRICULUM

🏆 MAR 2022	PHD. in COMPUTER SCIENCE, ATILF, Université de Lorraine , Nancy TITLE: “ On the Status of Word Embeddings as Implementations of the Distributional Hypothesis ”
JAN 2022	WINTER SCHOOL in MACHINE LEARNING, ALPS 2022 , Online
JUL 2019	SUMMER SCHOOL in MACHINE LEARNING, DeepLearn 2019 , Warsaw
JUL 2018	Master of Science in COMPUTATIONAL LINGUISTICS, Université Paris Diderot , Paris
JUL 2015	Bachelor of Science in COMPUTATIONAL LINGUISTICS, Université Paris Diderot , Paris

LANGUAGE SKILLS

NATIVE	French & English
SOME PROFICIENCY	German, Japanese & Finnish

SCIENTIFIC OUTREACH

TEACHING

JAN 2025–MAR 2025	Lectures on Mathematics for linguists , at UNIVERSITY OF HELSINKI
MAR 2023–JUN 2024	Lectures on Natural Language Understanding , at UNIVERSITY OF HELSINKI
AUG 2023	Lecture on Multilingual Machine Translation , within the 16 TH MT MARATHON Co-lecturer with J. TIEDEMANN and R. VÁZQUEZ.
OCT 2019–JAN 2021	Practical Lectures on Programming (Python), Shell and TeX , at UNIVERSITÉ DE LORRAINE
NOV 2018–FEB 2021	Lectures on Lexical Resources , at UNIVERSITÉ DE LORRAINE

SUPERVISION

SEP 2025–OCT 2026	Supervising three NLP Masters 2 students Topics: Impact of loan words on MT evaluation; Bilingual lexicon induction in Basque; Hallucination mitigation in summarization.
SEP 2025–OCT 2026	Supervising one NLP Bachelor student Topics: An error taxonomy for definition modeling.
NOV 2024–AUG 2025	Supervising two NLP Masters 2 students Topics: Hallucination & sycophancy; LLMs and frame semantics.
JAN 2025–AUG 2025	Supervising one NLP Bachelor student Topics: Definition modeling in Belarusian (work published).
JAN 2024–DEC 2024	Supervised two NLP Masters 1 students Topics: comparison of MT and LM objectives (work published); uncertainty-aware definition modeling.

MAY 2023–NOW	Co-supervision for a PhD student (Joseph Attieh) Dissertation topic: Optimizing Multilingual Language Models for more Efficient Inference.
JUN 2020–AUG 2020	Supervised two NLP Masters 1 students Topic: preliminary work for establishing comparable sets of word embeddings (work published).

FUNDING APPLICATIONS

OCT 2026	ACADEMY RESEARCH FELLOWSHIP from the Research Council of Finland (696 632€) For studying the relationship between training data and hallucinations.
OCT 2025	HSSH CATALYST Grant (13 000€) Co-written with Raúl VÁZQUEZ. For comparing annotation practices in NLP.
JUN 2025	Grant from the TIIETOTEKNIKAAN TUTKIMUSSÄÄTIÖ (5 000€) Co-written with Raúl VÁZQUEZ. For developing a multilingual dataset of LLM hallucinations.
MAR 2025	Grant from the FINNISH SOCIETY OF SCIENCES AND LETTERS (20 000€) Co-written with Raúl VÁZQUEZ. For developing a multilingual & multimodal dataset of LLM hallucinations.
MAR 2025	Grant from the FACULTY OF ARTS OF THE UNIVERSITY OF HELSINKI (1 785€) For conference attendance (IWCS) and workshop organization (BriGap2).
JAN 2025	ERC PROOF-OF-CONCEPT grant (150 000€) Co-written with Jörg TIEDEMANN and Raúl VÁZQUEZ. For developing resources for modular translation.
JUN 2024	Grant from the OTTO MALM FOUNDATION (5 000€) Co-written with Raúl VÁZQUEZ. For developing a multilingual dataset of LLM hallucinations.
JUN 2023	Grant from OSKAR ÖFFLUND FOUNDATION (5 000€) Co-written with Raúl VÁZQUEZ. For developing a dataset of hallucinations in NLP models.

ORGANIZATION DUTIES

SEP 2025–OCT 2026	Co-organizer for the SHROOM-VISIONS shared task
JUN 2025–DEC 2025	Co-organizer for the SHROOM-CAP shared task
APR 2025–DEC 2025	Co-organizer for the CHOMPS workshop
FEB 2025–SEP 2025	Co-organizer for the BRIGAP2 workshop
DEC 2024–AUG 2025	Co-organizer for the 18th MT MARATHON summer school
MAY 2024–JUL 2025	Co-organizer for the MU-SHROOM shared-task
DEC 2023–MAY 2024	Co-organizer for the AXOLOTL'24 shared-task
OCT 2023–MAR 2024	Co-organizer for the MOOMIN workshop
MAY 2023–JUL 2024	Co-organizer for the SHROOM shared-task
JUN 2021–JUL 2022	Co-organizer for the CODWoE shared-task

SCIENTIFIC PANELS & ASSESSMENT, PUBLIC OUTREACH

2025	Grant proposal reviewing for the Narodowe Centrum Nauki
2024, 2025	Expert evaluator, DSTrain postdoctoral programme (MSCA Cofund, University of Oslo)
APR 2021–DEC 2021	Member of the strategic committee “Université – Recherche – Santé”

AWARDS

JUL 2026	Poster spotlight at the MECH INTERP 2026 ICML WORKSHOP.
JUL 2026	Gold Reviewer at ICML 2026
JUN 2025	Best task runner-up at SEMEVAL 2025
JUN 2024	Best task paper award at SEMEVAL 2024
JUN 2024	Best paper award at INSIGHTS FROM NEGATIVE RESULTS 2024
DEC 2023	Outstanding reviewer at EMNLP 2023
JUN 2023	Best PhD dissertation award (prix de thèse ATALA).

PUBLICATIONS

- 🏆 JUL 2026 [Language Models Learn Universal Representations of Numbers and Here's Why You Should Care](#)
M. STEFÁNIK,* T. MICKUS,* M. KADLČÍK,* B. HØJER, M. SPIEGEL, R. VÁZQUEZ, A. SINHA, J. KUCHAR, P. MONDORF & P. STENETORP. ACL 2026.
- MAY 2026 [Confabulations from ACL Publications \(CAP\): A Dataset for Scientific Hallucination Detection](#)
F. GAMBA, A. SINHA, T. MICKUS, R. VÁZQUEZ, P. BHAMIDIPATI, C. SAVELLI, A. CHATTOPADHYAY, L. ZANELLA, Y. KANKANAMPATI, B. A. REMESH, A. CHANDRAMANIA, R. AGARWAL, C. LI, I. BUHNILA & R. MAMIDI. LREC 2026.
- APR 2026 [Knowledge Distillation as Decontamination? Revisiting the “Data Laundering” Concern](#)
H. LUO, R. VÁZQUEZ, T. MICKUS, F. GINTER & J. TIEDEMANN. ICLR 2026.
- DEC 2025 [SHROOM-CAP: Shared Task on Hallucinations and Related Observable Overgeneration Mistakes in Crosslingual Analyses of Publications](#)
A. SINHA,* F. GAMBA,* R. VÁZQUEZ, T. MICKUS, A. CHATTOPADHYAY, L. ZANELLA, B. A. REMESH, Y. KANKANAMPATI, A. CHANDRAMANIA & R. AGARWAL. CHOMPS 2025 (AAACL 2025).
- NOV 2025 [Pre-trained Language Models Learn Remarkably Accurate Representations of Numbers](#)
M. KADLČÍK,* M. STEFÁNIK,* T. MICKUS,* J. KUCHAR & M. SPIEGEL. EMNLP 2025
- NOV 2025 [Can Out-of-Distribution Evaluations Uncover Reliance on Prediction Shortcuts? A Case Study in Question Answering](#)
M. STEFÁNIK, T. MICKUS, M. KADLČÍK, M. SPIEGEL & J. KUCHAR. Findings of EMNLP 2025
- NOV 2025 [Explainable linguistic variety classification: The case of Bosnian-Croatian-Montenegrin-Serbian](#)
A. MILETIĆ, T. MICKUS & Y. SCHERRER. ReLDI Konferencija.
- JUL 2025 [Adapting Definition Modeling for New Languages: A Case Study on Belarusian](#)
D. KAZAKOUSKAYA, T. MICKUS, & J. SIEWERT. SlavicNLP 2025 (ACL 2025).
- 🏆 JUL 2025 [SemEval-2025 Task 3: Mu-SHROOM, the multilingual shared task on hallucinations and related observable overgeneration mistakes](#)
R. VÁZQUEZ,* T. MICKUS,* E. ZOSA, T. VAHTOLA, J. TIEDEMANN, A. SINHA, V. SEGONNE, F. SÁNCHEZ-VEGA, A. RAGANATO, J. LIBOVICK , J. KARLGREN, S. JI, J. HELCL, L. GUILLOU, O. DE GIBERT, J. BENGOTXEA, J. ATTIEH & M. APIDIANAKI. SemEval 2025 (ACL 2025).
- JUL 2025 [Your Model is Overconfident, and Other Lies We Tell Ourselves](#)
T. MICKUS,* A. SINHA* & R. VÁZQUEZ. ACL 2025.
- NOV 2024 [A Comparison of Language Modeling and Translation as Multilingual Pretraining Objectives](#)
Z. LI, S. JI,* T. MICKUS,* V. SEGONNE & J. TIEDEMANN. EMNLP 2024.
- AUG 2024 [Domain-specific or Uncertainty-aware models: Does it *really* make a difference for biomedical text classification?](#)
A. SINHA, T. MICKUS, M. CLAUSEL, M. CONSTANT & X. COUBEZ. BioNLP 2024 (ACL 2024).
- AUG 2024 [AxoLoTL'24 Shared Task on Multilingual Explainable Semantic Change Modeling](#)
M. FEDOROVA, T. MICKUS, N. PARTANEN, J. SIEWERT, E. SPAZIANI & A. KUTUZOV. LChange'24 (ACL 2024).
- AUG 2024 [Isotropy, Clustering, and Classifiers](#)
T. MICKUS, S.-A. GRÖNNROOS & J. ATTIEH. ACL 2024.
- JUN 2024 [Stranger than Paradigm: Word Embedding Benchmarks Don't Align With Morphology](#)
T. MICKUS & M. COPOT. SCiL 2024.
- JUN 2024 [Language Models and the Paradigmatic Axis](#)
T. MICKUS. SCiL 2024.
- JUN 2024 [The Emergence of High-Level Semantics in a Signaling Game](#)
T. BERNARD, T. MICKUS & H. TAKAMURA. *SEM 2024 (NAACL 2024).
- 🏆 JUN 2024 [I Have an Attention Bridge to Sell You: Generalization Capabilities of Modular Translation Architectures](#)
T. MICKUS, J. ATTIEH & R. VÁZQUEZ. Workshop on Insights from Negative Results in NLP 2024 (NAACL 2024).
- 🏆 JUN 2024 [Semeval-2024 Task 6: SHROOM – A Shared-task on Hallucinations and Related Observable Overgeneration Mistakes](#)
T. MICKUS, E. ZOSA, R. VÁZQUEZ, T. VAHTOLA, J. TIEDEMANN, V. SEGONNE, A. RAGANATO & M. APIDIANAKI. SEMEVAL 2024 (NAACL 2024).
- MAY 2024 [Can machine translation bridge multilingual pretraining and cross-lingual transfer learning?](#)
S. JI, T. MICKUS, V. SEGONNE & J. TIEDEMANN. LREC-CoLING 2024.
- MAR 2024 [MAMMOTH 🐘 Massively Multilingual Modular Open Translation @ Helsinki](#)
T. MICKUS,* S.-A. GRÖNNROOS,* J. ATTIEH, M. BOGGIA, O. DE GIBERT, S. JI, N. LOPPI, A. RAGANATO, R. VÁZQUEZ & J. TIEDEMANN. EACL 2024.
- DEC 2023 [Why bother with geometry? On the relevance of linear decompositions of Transformer embeddings](#)
T. MICKUS & R. VÁZQUEZ. BLACKBOXNLP 2023 (EMNLP 2023).

- DEC 2023 [Grounded and Well-rounded: A Methodological Approach to the Study of Cross-modal and Cross-lingual Grounding](#)
T. MICKUS, E. ZOSA & D. PAPERNO. Findings of EMNLP 2023.
- JUL 2023 [„Mann” is to “Donna” as 「国王」 is to « Reine »: Adapting the Analogy Task for Multilingual and Contextual Embeddings.](#)
T. MICKUS, E. CALÓ, L. JACQMIN, D. PAPERNO & M. CONSTANT. *SEM 2023 (ACL 2023).
- JUL 2023 [So many design choices: Improving and interpreting neural agent communication in signaling games](#)
T. BERNARD & T. MICKUS. Findings of the ACL 2023.
- JUN 2023 [Definition Modeling: To Model Definitions. Generating Definitions With Little to No Semantics](#)
V. SEGONNE* & T. MICKUS.* IWCS 2023.
- MAY 2023 [Dozens of Translation Directions or Millions of Shared Parameters? Comparing Two Types of Multilinguality in Modular Machine Translation](#)
M. BOGGIA, S.-A. GRÖNROOS, N. LOPPI, T. MICKUS, A. RAGANATO, J. TIEDEMANN & R. VÁZQUEZ. NoDALiDA 2023.
- DEC 2022 [Idiosyncratic Frequency as a Measure of Derivation vs Inflection](#)
M. COPOT, T. MICKUS & O. BONAMI. In *Journal of Language Modeling*.
- SEP 2022 [How to Dissect a Muppet: The Structure of Transformer Embedding Spaces.](#)
T. MICKUS, D. PAPERNO & M. CONSTANT. In *Transactions of the ACL*.
- 🏆 JUL 2022 [Semeval-2022 Task 1: CODWOE – Comparing Dictionaries and Word Embeddings](#)
T. MICKUS, K. VAN DEEMTER, M. CONSTANT & D. PAPERNO. SemEval 2022 (NAACL 2022).
- DEC 2021 [About Neural Networks and Writing Definitions](#)
T. MICKUS, D. PAPERNO & M. CONSTANT; DSNA 2021.
- AUG 2021 [A Game Interface to Study Semantic Grounding in Text-Based Models](#)
T. MICKUS, M. CONSTANT & D. PAPERNO. Games & NLP (IEEE CoG).
- DEC 2020 [What Meaning-Form Correlation Has to Compose With](#)
T. MICKUS, T. BERNARD & D. PAPERNO. COLING 2020.
- JUN 2020 [Génération Automatique de Définitions pour le Français](#)
T. MICKUS, M. CONSTANT & D. PAPERNO. TALN 2020.
- JAN 2020 [What do you mean, BERT? Assessing BERT as a Distributional Semantics Model](#)
T. MICKUS, D. PAPERNO, M. CONSTANT & K. VAN DEEMTER. SCiL 2020.
- SEP 2019 [Mark my Word: a Sequence-to-sequence Approach to Definition Modeling](#)
T. MICKUS, D. PAPERNO & M. CONSTANT. DL4NLP workshop (NoDALiDA 2019).
- JAN 2019 [Distributional Effects of Gender Contrasts Across Categories](#)
T. MICKUS, O. BONAMI & D. PAPERNO. SCiL 2019.